

Digital Citizenship & Online Safety

Six print-and-go lessons on footprints, account security, data, group chats, verification, and scams.



THE SIX LESSONS

- | | |
|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1 Footprint and Reputation | 4 Group Chats and Pile-Ons |
| 2 Account Security | 5 Checking What You See |
| 3 Data Trails and Settings | 6 Scams and Manipulation |



6 full lessons



39 pages



No prep



Print and go



Sub friendly



WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ Six complete lessons with teacher notes and student pages
- ✓ Reputation, passwords and 2FA, data trails, pile-ons, deepfakes, and scams
- ✓ Skills rubric, six exit tickets, and a full answer key
- ✓ Family letter and a student help sheet
- ✓ Standards alignment for ISTE, CASEL, and AASL



Start Here

Six lessons that treat middle schoolers as capable of handling the real picture, written so that any teacher can run them straight from the page.

What this pack is

- **Six complete lessons** covering the areas students actually get caught by: footprints, passwords, privacy, unkindness, false information, and scams.
- **Every lesson runs from the page.** Teacher notes on one side, student pages on the other. No slides to prepare, no accounts to create, no websites to visit.
- **Print and go.** Black and white printing works. Nothing here breaks if the internet is down.
- **Written for any teacher**, not just the tech teacher. If you have never taught this before, the teacher page tells you exactly what to say and do.

THE THREE-PART SHAPE OF EVERY LESSON

PART	TIME	WHAT HAPPENS
Open	5 to 8 min	A question or a short scenario on the board. Everyone has an opinion, so everyone talks.
Work	20 to 30 min	Students complete the pages. You circulate. The pages carry the content, so you are free to listen.
Land	7 to 10 min	A short share-back and an exit ticket. This is where the rule gets stated out loud.

PRINT SETUP

Student pages are the ones with a **Grades 6 to 8** footer and space to write. Print them single-sided if students will keep them in a folder, double-sided to save paper. Teacher pages are marked **TEACHER** in the top right corner and are not meant for students.

A NOTE ON TONE

These lessons are deliberately not frightening. Middle schoolers detect exaggeration immediately, and once they decide you have overstated a risk they discount everything else you said. Every lesson gives them something concrete to **do**, and the message running through all six is that reporting a problem early is always the right move and never gets them into trouble.

What Is Inside

Six lessons, plus everything you need to run them and check what stuck.

THE LESSONS

#	LESSON	THE QUESTION IT ANSWERS	TIME
Lesson 1	Footprint and Reputation	Your online record was assembled by accident. Would you have chosen it on purpose?	50 min
Lesson 2	Account Security	If one of your passwords leaked tomorrow, how many of your accounts would fall?	50 min
Lesson 3	Data Trails and Settings	The app is free. So what are you paying with?	50 min
Lesson 4	Group Chats and Pile-Ons	Almost nobody starts a pile-on. So why do they get so big?	50 min
Lesson 5	Checking What You See	It looks real, it sounds confident, and lots of people shared it. How would you actually know?	50 min
Lesson 6	Scams and Manipulation	Scams are written by professionals to work on adults. So what is the defense?	50 min

ALSO INCLUDED

SECTION	USE IT FOR
Standards alignment	Dropping into a unit plan or showing a coordinator what this covers.
Pacing options	Running the pack over one week, six weeks, or a single day.
Before you teach	Two pages of guidance on disclosures, privacy, and what not to ask students to share.
Skills rubric	A single-page rubric that works across all six lessons.
Exit tickets	Six short tickets, one per lesson, cut-and-go.
Family letter	An editable-tone letter home explaining what students are learning and why.
Help sheet	A page students fill in <i>before</i> they need it, listing who they would tell.
Answer key	Full answers, including model responses for the open questions.

HOW LONG IT TAKES

All six lessons run about **5 hours** of class time. Most teachers spread them across six weeks, one lesson a week. You can also pull a single lesson out and run it on its own; nothing depends on anything before it except the vocabulary, which is defined again each time.

Standards Alignment

Use these when you need to justify the time. Copy the codes straight into a unit plan.

ISTE STANDARDS FOR STUDENTS

CODE	STANDARD	LESSONS
1.2.a	Students cultivate and manage their digital identity and reputation and are aware of the permanence of their actions.	1
1.2.b	Students engage in positive, safe, legal and ethical behavior when using technology.	4, 6
1.2.c	Students demonstrate an understanding of and respect for the rights and obligations of using intellectual property.	1, 5
1.2.d	Students manage their personal data to maintain digital privacy and security and are aware of data-collection technology.	2, 3, 6
1.3.b	Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources.	5
1.7.b	Students use collaborative technologies to work with others, including peers and experts, in a respectful manner.	4

CASEL COMPETENCIES

COMPETENCY	HOW THE PACK ADDRESSES IT	LESSONS
Self-awareness	Students identify the emotional lever a message is pulling before responding to it.	5, 6
Self-management	The protocols in Lessons 4 and 6 create a rehearsed pause between impulse and action.	4, 6
Social awareness	The pile-on analysis makes the asymmetry between sender and target explicit.	4
Relationship skills	Students script and rehearse the upstander message and the disclosure conversation.	4, 6
Responsible decision-making	Every lesson closes with a specific committed action rather than a general intention.	All

AASL NATIONAL SCHOOL LIBRARY STANDARDS

SHARED FOUNDATION	ALIGNMENT	LESSONS
Inquire	Lateral reading and provenance checking as a habit rather than an assignment.	5
Include	Students consider perspectives of targets, participants, and bystanders.	4
Collaborate	Group chat norms and the cost of silence in a group.	4
Curate	Students evaluate what is worth sharing and what should stop with them.	1, 5
Engage	Ethical handling of information about oneself and others, including consent.	1, 3, 4

STATE STANDARDS

Most states now require some form of internet safety or media literacy instruction. The lesson objectives on each teacher page are written as observable student behaviors, which makes them easy to map onto whatever wording your state uses. If you need a specific crosswalk, the objectives are the piece to quote.

Pacing Options

Three ways to run the same six lessons. Pick the one that matches the time you actually have.

OPTION A: ONE LESSON A WEEK FOR SIX WEEKS

The version that sticks best. A week between lessons gives students time to notice the thing you named, which is what turns a lesson into a habit. Open each week by asking whether anyone saw last week's idea show up.

OPTION B: ONE INTENSIVE WEEK

DAY	LESSON	NOTE
Monday	Lesson 1: Footprint and Reputation	Sets the frame. Do not skip this one.
Tuesday	Lesson 2: Account Security	The most concrete lesson. Highest immediate payoff.
Wednesday	Lesson 3: Data Trails and Settings	Ends with an action students can take that night.
Thursday	Lesson 4: Group Chats and Pile-Ons	Allow extra discussion time. This is the one they talk about.
Friday	Lessons 5 and 6, shortened	Lesson 5 page 1, then Lesson 6 in full plus the help sheet.

OPTION C: A SINGLE DAY

Run Lessons 1, 2 and 6. Skip the extension tasks and use the exit tickets as the only written record. This is the version to use for an assembly day, a sub day, or the first week of school.

IF YOU ONLY HAVE ONE PERIOD, EVER

The 45-minute version

- **Minutes 0 to 10.** Lesson 1 opener and the first student page only.
- **Minutes 10 to 25.** Lesson 2 student pages. This is the highest-value single activity in the pack.
- **Minutes 25 to 40.** Lesson 6 scenario cards, discussed as a whole class rather than written.
- **Minutes 40 to 45.** The help sheet at the back. Every student fills it in and keeps it.

SUBSTITUTE FRIENDLY

Every teacher page is self-contained, so a substitute can run any lesson cold. Leave the teacher page and the matching student pages on the desk and nothing else needs explaining.

Before You Teach

This topic reaches into students' actual lives. A few decisions made in advance keep the room safe.

THE DESIGN RULE BEHIND THIS PACK

No page in this pack asks a student to write down a real password, a real account name, a real message they received, or a real person's name. Every scenario is fictional. This is deliberate: worksheets get left on desks, collected, photographed, and taken home. Please keep this rule if you adapt anything.

WHAT TO SAY IN THE FIRST TWO MINUTES

"Over the next few weeks we are going to talk about being online, and I am going to treat you as people who already use this stuff and know things I do not. Some of what we cover may be close to something you have experienced. You never have to share anything personal here. If something comes up you want to talk about, come find me afterward."

IF A STUDENT DISCLOSES SOMETHING

WHAT YOU HEAR	WHAT TO DO
A student names something that happened to them in front of the class	Thank them, keep your face neutral, and move the conversation back to the general case. Follow up privately after the lesson.
A student writes something concerning on a page	Do not read it aloud or return it to the pile. Follow your school's reporting process the same day.
A student names another student as the person who did something	Stop the naming immediately and kindly. Say that the class talks about behavior, not people. Record it and pass it on.
A student says something that suggests harm to themselves or someone else	This goes to your counselor or designated safeguarding lead the same day, no exceptions and no promises of secrecy.

DO NOT PROMISE CONFIDENTIALITY

If a student says "can I tell you something but you can't tell anyone," the honest answer is that you will keep it as private as you can, but if someone is being hurt you have to pass it on to one specific person whose job it is to help. Say this *before* they tell you, not after.

TWO THINGS WORTH CHECKING WITH YOUR SCHOOL FIRST

- **Your reporting pathway.** Know the name of the person you would go to, today, before you start Lesson 1. Write it on the teacher page.
- **Your device policy.** Some of these lessons discuss platform features. If your school has rules about naming specific apps, the lessons work without naming any.

Before You Teach: Handling the Hard Bits

THE FOUR QUESTIONS STUDENTS ALWAYS ASK

QUESTION	A STRAIGHT ANSWER
"Is my account already hacked?"	Usually not, but give the practical answer: change the password, turn on two-step verification, sign out other sessions, and check for forwarding rules.
"What if it already happened to me?"	Say: come see me after class. Do not invite them to explain in front of the room, and follow your school's process the same day.
"Why does it matter, I have nothing to hide?"	Reframe from hiding to control. It is not about secrets, it is about who gets to decide what is known about you and when.
"Can they really see my deleted messages?"	Sometimes, and it depends on the platform. The honest answer is that you should assume deletion removes it from your view, not from existence.

LANGUAGE THAT WORKS, AND LANGUAGE THAT BACKFIRES

INSTEAD OF	SAY
"Never talk to strangers online"	"Notice when someone you have not met wants secrecy or isolation"
"You will ruin your future"	"This record lasts longer than the mood you posted it in"
"Don't be stupid"	"These are designed by professionals to work on adults"
"Just don't use social media"	"Here is how to use it while giving away less"
"Tell me everything that happens"	"If something goes wrong, you will not be in trouble for telling me"

WHY THE SCARE APPROACH FAILS

Fear-based internet safety teaching has a poor evidence record. Students either decide the risk is exaggerated and discount everything you said, or they become anxious and stop telling adults anything. Both outcomes make them less safe. Every lesson here is built on **what to do** rather than **what to be afraid of**, which is why the exit tickets ask for an action, not a feeling.

PREPARE THESE THREE THINGS ONCE

1. **The help sheet.** Print one per student now. It is the last student page in this pack and it is the single most useful page in it.
2. **Your reporting name.** One person, first and last name, and where to find them. Students will ask.
3. **A copy of your school's acceptable use policy.** Students in the older lessons will ask what the actual rules are, and it lands better if you can show them.

A word about students who already know this

In every class there are two or three students who are more technically capable than most adults they know. They will be visibly bored by the password lesson. Use them: give them the extension task early, and ask them to explain one idea to the class in their own words. Students who are ahead here are usually ahead precisely because someone once explained it to them well.

Lesson 1: Footprint and Reputation

Students examine how a scattered set of ordinary posts adds up to a reputation they did not deliberately build.

Students will be able to

- Distinguish between what they post, what others post about them, and what is collected automatically.
- Explain why deletion does not reliably remove something.
- Audit a fictional profile and identify what a stranger could infer from it.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- Board
- Pens

Time: 50 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

Your online record was assembled by accident. Would you have chosen it on purpose?

RUNNING THE LESSON

- 0 to 8** **The three-column split**
Draw three columns on the board: **what I post**, **what others post about me**, **what is collected about me**. Ask students to fill them. Column one fills instantly. Columns two and three are where the conversation starts, and column three is usually the shortest, which is the point.
- 8 to 16** **Context collapse**
Explain the term. A joke that works in a group chat of four reads completely differently to a coach, an admissions officer, or a younger sibling. Nothing about the message changed; the audience did. This concept does more work than any list of rules.
- 16 to 32** **Student pages 1 and 2**
Students map their own footprint into the three categories, then audit a fictional student's profile. The audit asks what a stranger could **infer**, not just what is stated. That distinction is the learning.
- 32 to 43** **Student page 3**
The five-year test and a personal audit plan. Students write three specific actions, not vague intentions.
- 43 to 50** **Land it**
Ask for one thing anyone will actually change this week. Exit ticket 1 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Digital footprint	The complete record of your activity online, including the parts you did not create.
Passive footprint	Data collected about you without you posting anything: location, watch history, search history.
Inference	A conclusion someone draws about you from indirect evidence.
Context collapse	When something written for one audience is read by a completely different one.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Give the three-column categories with two examples already filled in each. The blank page is the obstacle here, not the concept.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to write the inference a stranger would draw from their own last five posts, then rate how accurate it is. Most find it is not wrong so much as incomplete, which is a sharper realization.

WATCH FOR

Avoid asking students to look up themselves or each other in class. It rewards the students with the largest footprints and can expose a student who has content online they did not consent to.

Three Kinds of Footprint

Read this first

Most people picture a digital footprint as the things they chose to post. That is only a third of it.

There is also what **other people** post about you, which you did not agree to and cannot delete. And there is what is **collected automatically**, which you never see: where you were, what you watched and for how long, what you searched and then deleted, what you typed and did not send.

MAP YOUR OWN

Fill each column with real examples. **Do not write anything private.** Categories, not confessions.

WHAT I POST	WHAT OTHERS POST ABOUT ME	WHAT IS COLLECTED ABOUT ME

QUESTION 1

Which column was hardest to fill in? What does that tell you?

QUESTION 2

You can delete something from column one. Explain why that does not necessarily remove it from the internet. Give **two** separate reasons.

QUESTION 3

Context collapse is when something written for one audience gets read by a different one. Describe a realistic example, using a fictional situation rather than a real one.

Audit a Profile

Below is a fictional student's public activity. Your job is to work out what a stranger could **infer**, not just what is written.

PUBLIC ACTIVITY FOR @RIVS_2011

Bio: "13. Northside. Track and cross country. RIP Grandpa Joe 2024."

Recent posts: A photo at a track meet in a Northside Middle uniform, number 47. A photo captioned "finally got my own room" showing a window view. Three photos from the same coffee shop on three different Saturdays. A post at 11:40pm saying "cannot sleep again."

Comments made: Six comments on one classmate's posts in a week. One comment saying "we always go Fridays."

Follows: A local pizza place, a dentist's office, three teachers, a running club that lists its meeting times publicly.

WHAT CAN A STRANGER WORK OUT?

WHAT THEY COULD FIGURE OUT	THE CLUES THAT GIVE IT AWAY	HOW CONFIDENT COULD THEY BE?

QUESTION 1

Nothing in this profile is a phone number or an address. Explain how a stranger could still work out where to find this person on a Saturday morning.

QUESTION 2

The 11:40pm post says nothing dangerous at all. Name **one** way it could still be used by someone who wanted to build trust with this student.

QUESTION 3

Which **single change** would reduce the risk here the most? Justify your choice.

The Five-Year Test

The question that actually works

Rules like "do not post anything bad" fail because nobody thinks their own post is bad at the moment they post it. A better question is specific and about time: **would I want the version of me five years from now to be judged on this?** Five years is far enough that you will have changed, and near enough that the post will still exist.

APPLY IT

THE POST	PASSES THE FIVE-YEAR TEST?	WHY
A photo of you winning a race		
A furious comment about a teacher, posted at midnight		
A joke that only your close friends would understand		
A strong political opinion you feel certain about right now		
A screenshot of a private conversation, shared to prove a point		

THE GENUINELY DIFFICULT ONE

Row 4 is hard. People are allowed to hold and state opinions, and self-censoring everything is not a good life. Write where you think the line is between **having a view** and **posting something you will regret**.

MY AUDIT PLAN

Write three **specific** actions you will take. "Be more careful" is not an action. "Turn off location tagging on my camera" is.

1

2

3

Name: _____ Date: _____

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Lesson 2: Account Security

Students learn why password reuse is the single biggest risk they carry, and how two-step verification changes the math.

Students will be able to

- Explain why reusing a password is more dangerous than using a weak one.
- Describe how two-step verification stops an attacker who already has the password.
- Sequence the correct response to a compromised account.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- Board
- Pens

Time: 50 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

If one of your passwords leaked tomorrow, how many of your accounts would fall?

RUNNING THE LESSON

0 to 8 The domino demonstration

Ask: hands up if you use the same password on more than one account. Most hands go up. Then explain: attackers do not guess your password, they buy it from a breach of a site you forgot you joined, then try it everywhere. One leak, every account. This lands harder than any lecture on password strength.

8 to 18 Length, then uniqueness, then 2FA

Order matters. A long password is good. A **different** long password per account is better. Two-step verification is better than both, because it protects you even when the password is already stolen. Write the three tiers on the board in that order.

18 to 33 Student pages 1 and 2

Students trace a breach through a fictional student's accounts, then compare security methods. The tracing exercise is the one that changes behavior.

33 to 44 Student page 3

Incident response sequencing and the account audit. Emphasize the order: **2FA-protected email first**, because email is the key to resetting everything else.

44 to 50 Land it

Ask: which account should you secure first, and why? Answer: email, because every other reset goes through it. Exit ticket 2 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Data breach	When a company's stored user data is stolen. Happens to large companies regularly.
Credential stuffing	Taking passwords leaked from one site and trying them on every other site.
Two-step verification (2FA)	A second proof of identity beyond the password, usually a code or an app approval.
Passkey	A login method that replaces the password with a key stored on your device. Nothing to leak.
Password manager	An app that generates and stores a different strong password for every account.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Provide the fictional accounts as cut-out cards so students physically knock them over as the breach spreads. The visual does the teaching.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to research what a password manager costs and write a one-paragraph recommendation to a parent, including the objection they expect and their answer to it.

WATCH FOR

Never ask a student to state, type, or write a real password. If a student says one out loud, stop them, and tell them privately afterward to change it.

One Leak, Every Account

Read this first

Attackers usually do not guess your password. They buy it. Large companies get breached, and millions of email-and-password pairs end up in lists that get traded and reused.

Then comes the automated part, called **credential stuffing**: software takes your leaked pair and tries it on hundreds of other sites. It does not need to be clever, because most people reuse passwords.

This is why **reusing a strong password is more dangerous than using a weak unique one**. A weak unique password loses you one account. A reused strong one loses you all of them.

TRACE THE DAMAGE

A fictional student used the same password on all of these. A game forum they joined in Grade 5 got breached. Work through what falls, and in what order.

ACCOUNT	DOES IT FALL?	WHAT CAN BE DONE WITH IT
Old game forum (the breached site)	Yes	
Email		
Social media		
School login		
A parent's shopping account they set up		

QUESTION 1

Why is **email** the most damaging account to lose, even if there is nothing interesting in it?

QUESTION 2

The breached site was a forum they had not opened in three years. Explain why old accounts you have forgotten about are a security problem.

Ranking the Defenses

Five ways to protect an account. Rank them, then explain the ranking.

- A. A long passphrase, but the same one on every account B. A different random password per account, stored in a password manager C. A short complicated password with symbols D. A long passphrase plus two-step verification E. A passkey

RANK	WHICH	WHY IT SITS THERE
1 (strongest)		
2		
3		
4		
5 (weakest)		

QUESTION 1

Two-step verification protects you **even when the attacker already knows your password**. Explain how.

QUESTION 2

Not all second steps are equal. A code sent by text message is weaker than an approval in an authenticator app. Suggest **one reason** why.

QUESTION 3

A friend says "a password manager is risky, it puts everything in one place." Write the strongest version of their argument, then write your answer to it.

THEIR ARGUMENT, AT ITS STRONGEST

YOUR ANSWER

Name: _____ Date: _____

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When an Account Is Compromised

PART A: PUT THESE IN ORDER

Number them 1 to 6. Order matters more than you would think.

- ☐ Change the password on every other account that used the same one
- ☐ Turn on two-step verification on the recovered account
- ☐ Secure your email account first, since password resets go through it
- ☐ Tell a trusted adult what happened
- ☐ Check for changes the attacker made: forwarding rules, recovery email, linked devices
- ☐ Sign out all other sessions

PART B: THE STEP PEOPLE FORGET

Attackers often add a **forwarding rule** or change the **recovery email**, so that even after you change your password they keep getting your mail. Explain why simply changing the password is not enough on its own.

PART C: SIGNS WORTH NOTICING

Write four signs that an account may have been accessed by someone else.

SIGN	WHY IT HAPPENS

PART D: MY AUDIT

Name the three accounts that would hurt most to lose, in order. You will secure these first.

1.

2.

3.

Lesson 3: Data Trails and Settings

Students look at what apps collect, what can be inferred from it, and which settings actually make a difference.

Students will be able to

- Distinguish between data given, data observed, and data inferred.
- Explain how a company can know something you never told it.
- Identify the small number of settings that meaningfully reduce data collection.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- Board
- Pens

Time: 50 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

The app is free. So what are you paying with?

RUNNING THE LESSON

0 to 8

Free is not free

Ask what a large social app costs to run. Servers, engineers, storage: enormous. Then ask what students pay. The answer is attention and data, and the second one is the one they have never priced.

8 to 18

Given, observed, inferred

Three tiers, on the board. **Given** is your name and birthday. **Observed** is what you watched, how long you paused, where you were. **Inferred** is the conclusion: your likely age, mood, income bracket, interests, who you probably know. Students consistently underestimate the third tier and it is the valuable one.

18 to 33

Student pages 1 and 2

Students sort data types, then work out what a company could infer about a fictional user from ordinary behavior. Push them past the obvious inferences.

33 to 44

Student page 3

Dark patterns and the settings audit. The settings list is deliberately short, because a list of thirty settings gets ignored.

44 to 50

Land it

Ask each student to name one setting they will check tonight. Exit ticket 3 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Metadata	Data about your data: when, where, from which device, for how long.
Inferred data	Conclusions a company draws about you that you never entered.
Permissions	What an app is allowed to reach: camera, microphone, contacts, location.
Dark pattern	An interface designed to steer you toward the choice the company wants.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Provide the sorting items pre-cut. For the inference activity, model the first two inferences aloud, thinking through the reasoning explicitly.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to find a dark pattern in a real sign-up flow they have seen and sketch it, labeling what it steers you toward and what the honest version would look like.

WATCH FOR

Some students will conclude that privacy is hopeless and disengage. Counter this directly: a small number of settings genuinely reduce collection, and the goal is fewer trails, not zero.

Given, Observed, Inferred

Read this first

When people picture data collection, they picture the sign-up form. That is the smallest part.

Given is what you typed in: name, birthday, email.

Observed is what you did: what you watched, how long you hovered, when you opened the app, where you were, which posts you scrolled past quickly.

Inferred is what they concluded: your likely mood, your probable interests, who you most likely know, how much money your household probably has. **You never told them any of this.**

SORT THESE

1. Your date of birth 2. How long you paused on a video 3. That you are probably left-handed 4. Your profile photo 5. The time of day you are most active 6. That you are probably in a relationship 7. Your phone's battery level 8. The Wi-Fi networks near you 9. That you probably know a specific person you have never messaged 10. Your typed but unsent messages

GIVEN	OBSERVED	INFERRED

QUESTION 1

Item 10 is typed but unsent messages. Explain why a company would keep something you deliberately chose not to send.

QUESTION 2

Item 8 is nearby Wi-Fi networks. What could a company work out from that, even with location turned off?

What They Could Work Out

A fictional user does nothing unusual. Work out what could be inferred anyway.

ONE WEEK OF ORDINARY ACTIVITY

Opens the app at 7:10am on weekdays and 10:30am on weekends. Watches cooking videos for long stretches, skips ads for cars in under two seconds. Messages the same four people daily and one person only late at night. Location shows the same building 8:30am to 3:15pm on weekdays. Searched for "how to know if you have the flu" on Tuesday. Battery is usually below 20% by evening. Connects to the same three Wi-Fi networks.

BUILD THE INFERENCES

WHAT COULD BE INFERRED	FROM WHICH SIGNALS	HOW USEFUL IS THIS TO AN ADVERTISER?

QUESTION 1

The Tuesday search was about health. Explain why health inferences are treated as more sensitive than inferences about, say, a preference for cooking videos.

QUESTION 2

One person is messaged only late at night. Write what could be inferred, and then write why that inference might be **completely wrong**. This matters: inferences are guesses, and decisions get made on them anyway.

Settings That Matter

DARK PATTERNS

Interfaces are designed to steer you. "Accept all" is a big colored button; "manage preferences" is small gray text. Turning something off takes four screens; turning it on takes one tap. None of that is accidental. Noticing the steering is most of the defense.

SPOT THE STEERING

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT IS STEERING YOU TOWARD
A large bright ACCEPT ALL button next to small gray text	
"Are you sure? You will miss out on personalized content"	
Location asked for while you are mid-task, with only "Allow" and "Not now"	
A privacy policy that is 40 pages long	

THE SHORT LIST THAT ACTUALLY WORKS

Check each one on your main device. Write the current setting and what you changed it to.

SETTING	NOW	CHANGED TO
Location: set to "while using" or "never", not "always"		
Ad personalization: off		
Microphone and camera: only apps that genuinely need them		
Contacts access: off for anything that is not a messaging app		
Account visibility: private rather than public		
Old apps you no longer use: deleted		

QUESTION

Someone says "I have nothing to hide, so I do not care." Write the strongest response you can, without suggesting they are doing anything wrong.

Lesson 4: Group Chats and Pile-Ons

Students examine how ordinary people participate in cruelty they would never start, and rehearse a specific way out.

Students will be able to

- Explain how diffusion of responsibility makes group cruelty escalate.
- Name and rehearse three upstander actions that do not require confrontation.
- Describe how to document and report harassment properly.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- Board
- Pens

Time: 50 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

Almost nobody starts a pile-on. So why do they get so big?

RUNNING THE LESSON

- 0 to 9** **The math of a pile-on**
Put a number on it. If forty people each send one message, the sender feels they contributed one fortieth. The target receives forty. Ask: whose experience is the real one? This framing removes the "it was just one comment" defense without accusing anyone.
- 9 to 18** **Why nobody steps in**
Name diffusion of responsibility explicitly. In a group of forty, everyone assumes somebody else is handling it. The fix is not being braver, it is being **specific**: the person who acts is usually the one who decided in advance what they would do.
- 18 to 33** **Student pages 1 and 2**
Students analyze a pile-on scenario, then work through the three upstander moves. Emphasize that the private message to the target is the highest-value and lowest-risk action, and that it costs nothing socially.
- 33 to 44** **Student page 3**
Documenting and reporting properly, plus the personal script. Have students actually write the message they would send. Rehearsed words get used; unrehearsed intentions do not.
- 44 to 50** **Land it**
Ask for the one sentence they would send to someone being piled on. Take three. Exit ticket 4 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Pile-on	Many people joining in on one target, each contributing a small amount.
Diffusion of responsibility	When everyone assumes somebody else will step in, so nobody does.
Upstander	Someone who acts to help, rather than watching.
Documenting	Saving evidence properly: screenshots with usernames, dates, and context visible.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Give the private-message script as a fill-in-the-blank frame. Many students want to help and stall entirely on wording.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to write the same situation from three perspectives: the target, someone who joined in, and someone who watched and did nothing. The third is the hardest and the most useful.

WATCH FOR

This lesson will resemble something real in your class. Keep the discussion on the fictional scenario. If a student names another student, stop it kindly, say that the class discusses behavior rather than people, and follow up privately.

How a Pile-On Grows

Read this first

Almost nobody sets out to run a campaign against another person. Pile-ons are built out of small contributions from people who each think they are doing almost nothing.

Two things make it grow. First, **the math is asymmetric**: you send one message, the target receives all of them. Second, **diffusion of responsibility**: in a large group, everyone assumes somebody else will say something, so nobody does.

THE SCENARIO

A student posts a video of themselves attempting a difficult skateboard trick and failing. Someone reposts it to a group chat of 60 with a mocking caption. Over two days: 34 people react with laughing emojis, 11 add their own comment, 4 make edits or memes of the clip, 2 send it to other chats, and 1 person messages the student directly to check if they are OK. Nobody else says anything.

QUESTION 1

Count how many people did something that added to it. Then write what each of those people would probably say if you asked whether they had been unkind.

QUESTION 2

Fifty-two people saw it and said nothing. Write **two** reasons a person might stay silent even when they think something is wrong.

QUESTION 3

The person who made the edits and memes would say they did not write a single mean word. Explain why that defense does not hold.

QUESTION 4

One person messaged the target privately. Nobody else saw it, so it changed nothing publicly. Explain why it may still have been the most valuable thing anyone did.

Three Moves That Work

The three moves

- 1 **Go sideways, not head on.** Message the target privately. You do not have to challenge anyone publicly, which is the part most people are afraid of. One sentence is enough.
- 2 **Starve it.** No reactions, no comments, no forwarding, no screenshots to other chats. Even a comment telling people off increases the reach. Engagement is fuel regardless of which side it is on.
- 3 **Document and report.** Screenshot with usernames and dates visible, report in the app, and tell an adult. This is the only move that stops a repeat offender.

CHOOSE YOUR MOVE

SITUATION	MOVE(S)	WHAT EXACTLY WOULD YOU DO
A pile-on in a chat you are in, target is not in the chat		
A rumor about a classmate spreading fast		
Someone anonymous repeatedly targeting you		
A friend of yours is the one leading it		
You realize a post of yours started something		

THE HARDEST ROW

Row 4 is the one people avoid. Write what you would actually say to a friend who was leading a pile-on, in a way that does not end the friendship but does not pretend it is fine either.

Document, Report, Say Something

PART A: DOCUMENTING PROPERLY

A screenshot is only useful as evidence if it shows enough. Mark each item **needed** or **not needed**.

IN THE SCREENSHOT	NEEDED?	WHY
The username of the person who posted it		
The date and time		
The messages before and after, for context		
Your own reply		
The name of the chat or group		

PART B: REPORT IN TWO PLACES

Reporting in the app and telling an adult do different jobs. Explain what each one achieves that the other does not.

REPORTING IN THE APP	TELLING AN ADULT

PART C: WRITE THE MESSAGE

Write the actual message you would send to someone being piled on. Short is better. Do not offer to fix it, just make contact.

PART D: WRITE THE OTHER ONE

Now write what you would say to an adult when reporting it. Include what happened, who was involved, and what you want to happen next.

WHY REHEARSING MATTERS

People who help are rarely braver than people who do not. They have usually just decided in advance what they would say. You have now written it down, which means you are far more likely to send it.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Lesson 5: Checking What You See

Students learn lateral reading and how to handle images and video that may be edited or generated.

Students will be able to

- Use lateral reading to check a source rather than staying on the page.
- Explain why images and video are no longer proof on their own.
- State a verdict of uncertain when the evidence does not support a conclusion.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- Board
- Pens

Time: 50 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

It looks real, it sounds confident, and lots of people shared it. How would you actually know?

RUNNING THE LESSON

- 0 to 9 Professional does not mean true**
Point out that a convincing website costs nothing to make, and that AI can produce a photograph of an event that never happened in seconds. The old signals of credibility, such as looking professional and being confident, are now worthless. Say that plainly.
- 9 to 19 Lateral reading**
The key skill. Instead of staring harder at the page you are on, **open a new tab and look up the source**. Fact-checkers do this and most people do not; it is the single biggest difference between the two groups. Demonstrate the move on the board with a fictional site name.
- 19 to 34 Student pages 1 and 2**
Students practice lateral reading and then work through claims including one that cannot be resolved. Resist letting them force a verdict on that one.
- 34 to 45 Student page 3**
Synthetic media and the provenance questions. The point is not to spot fakes by eye, which is increasingly impossible, but to ask where something came from.
- 45 to 50 Land it**
Ask what a fact-checker does that most people do not. Answer: leaves the page. Exit ticket 5 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Lateral reading	Leaving the page to see what other sources say about it, rather than judging it by how it looks.
Provenance	Where something originally came from, and whether it has been altered since.
Synthetic media	Images, audio, or video generated or altered by AI.
Reverse image search	Searching using a picture rather than words, to find where else it has appeared.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Give the lateral reading move as three fixed questions written on a card students keep on the desk: who runs this, what do others say about them, and what is the original source.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to write a convincing false claim, then a paragraph explaining precisely which check would defeat it. Writing the defense is the assessment, not writing the claim.

WATCH FOR

Use fictional examples rather than live political ones. Real current examples turn a skills lesson into an argument about the topic, and students disengage along the lines their families already hold.

Read Laterally

The move that separates experts from everyone else

When most people meet an unfamiliar website, they read it harder. They look at the design, the tone, the references, the "About Us" page. All of that is written by the site itself, so all of it can be false.

Professional fact-checkers do the opposite. Within seconds they **leave the page** and search for what other, independent sources say about it. This is called **lateral reading**, and it is faster as well as more accurate.

THE THREE LATERAL QUESTIONS

- 1 **Who runs this?** Not what they say about themselves. What do independent sources say?
- 2 **What is the original source?** Most posts are three steps from the actual study, report, or event. Walk back to it.
- 3 **Who else reports this?** If something significant happened, independent outlets cover it. Silence is information.

PRACTICE

For each, write the **first search you would run** and what you would be looking for.

WHAT YOU MEET	YOUR FIRST SEARCH	WHAT WOULD CONVINCE YOU
A site called The Daily Health Report says a common food is dangerous		
A post says "a new study proves" something, with no link		
An account with 800k followers makes a claim about your city		
A screenshot of a news headline, with no article attached		

QUESTION

Row 4 is a screenshot of a headline. Explain why a screenshot is weaker evidence than a link, and what you would do about it.

Four Claims

Run the three lateral questions on each. One of these cannot be resolved with the information given, and **uncertain** is the correct answer for it.

CLAIM A

A post with 200k shares: "BREAKING: a local school district is banning backpacks starting Monday." No source named. The account posts similar content daily.

WHO RUNS IT?	ORIGINAL SOURCE?	WHO ELSE REPORTS IT?	VERDICT

CLAIM B

A university press release, on the university's own site, reporting findings from a study by its own researchers. The study is linked and published in a journal.

WHO RUNS IT?	ORIGINAL SOURCE?	WHO ELSE REPORTS IT?	VERDICT

CLAIM C

A well-made video of a public figure saying something startling. The audio matches the lips. It was posted by an account created three weeks ago.

WHO RUNS IT?	ORIGINAL SOURCE?	WHO ELSE REPORTS IT?	VERDICT

CLAIM D

A person posts that a product they bought made them ill. They have a normal-looking account with years of history. There is no other report of the same problem.

WHO RUNS IT?	ORIGINAL SOURCE?	WHO ELSE REPORTS IT?	VERDICT

Question: Which claim is genuinely uncertain, and what would it take to settle it?

When Images Are Not Evidence

THE THING THAT HAS CHANGED

For most of history, a photograph was reasonable proof that something happened. That is no longer true. Convincing images, audio, and video can be generated in seconds, and the telltale flaws people were taught to look for are disappearing fast. **Spotting fakes by eye is not a reliable strategy.** Asking where something came from is.

PROVENANCE QUESTIONS

Where did this first appear? Run a reverse image search. Old photos recycled for new events are far more common than generated ones.

Who posted it first, and what do they normally post?

Is there a second angle? Real public events get filmed by many people. One clip and no others is a warning sign.

Does the claim need this to be true? If the image is the only evidence, be careful.

APPLY IT

THE MEDIA	WHICH QUESTION HELPS MOST	WHAT YOU WOULD DO
A photo of a flooded street with a shark in it		
Audio of a principal announcing an unlikely rule change		
A photo of a crowd, used to show how big an event was		
A video of a celebrity endorsing an investment app		

QUESTION 1

Row 4 combines synthetic media with a scam. Explain why that combination is especially effective.

QUESTION 2

If convincing fakes are easy to make, some people conclude that nothing can be trusted and give up. Write why that conclusion is also a problem, and what a better response would be.

Lesson 6: Scams and Manipulation

Students learn the manipulation techniques behind online scams, including what to do if someone pressures them for images or money.

Students will be able to

- Name the manipulation levers common to nearly all scams.
- Identify a scam in an unfamiliar message.
- State exactly what to do if someone pressures them, including who to contact.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- The help sheet from the back of this pack
- Pens

Time: 50 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

Scams are written by professionals to work on adults. So what is the defense?

RUNNING THE LESSON

0 to 9

Reframe the shame

Open by saying clearly that scams are designed by teams of professionals, tested on thousands of people, and refined until they work. Falling for one is not stupidity. Say this first, because the shame is what stops students reporting, and reporting is the entire point of the lesson.

9 to 19

The four levers

Urgency, authority, reward, and secrecy. Nearly every scam pulls at least two. Write them up. Then note that secrecy is the one that separates a scam from a genuine offer, because a legitimate organization never needs you to hide it from your parents.

19 to 33

Student pages 1 and 2

Students identify levers in messages, then work through scenarios. Page 2 includes a scenario about being pressured for images. Preview this before you teach: it is written without graphic detail, and the three rules are the whole content.

33 to 45

Student page 3 and the help sheet

The response protocol and the help sheet from the back of this pack. Every student fills the help sheet in during class.

45 to 50

Land it

Say the three rules aloud together: **do not send, do not pay, tell someone.** Exit ticket 6 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Social engineering

Manipulating a person rather than breaking a system.

Phishing

A fake message designed to make you hand over a password or personal information.

Grooming

An adult building trust with a young person in order to exploit them.

Sextortion

Threatening to share intimate images unless the victim pays or sends more.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Reduce the message set from six to four and read each aloud before students annotate.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to rewrite one of the scam messages so that it would be more convincing, then explain what defense would still catch it. The second half is the assessment.

WATCH FOR

This lesson may surface a live situation. Watch for a student who goes quiet, stops writing, or asks an unusually specific question. Check in privately at the end of the period rather than in front of the class, and follow your school's reporting process the same day.

The Four Levers

BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

Scams are built by professionals, tested on thousands of people, and refined until they work. Adults with security jobs fall for them. **Being caught by one is not a sign that you were careless or stupid.** The only thing that makes it worse is not telling anyone.

Every scam pulls at least two of these

URGENCY. Act now. Offer expires. Account closing today. The rush exists so that you do not check.

AUTHORITY. Pretending to be your school, a company, the police, or someone you know. Authority makes people comply without questioning.

REWARD. Free money, free items, a prize, an opportunity. The reward is sized to be just believable.

SECRECY. Do not tell your parents. Keep this between us. **This is the decisive one.** No legitimate organization or genuine friend ever needs you to hide something from a trusted adult.

IDENTIFY THE LEVERS

Write **U**, **A**, **R**, or **S** for each. Most have more than one.

THE MESSAGE	LEVERS	THE GIVEAWAY
"Your school account will be deleted in 24 hours. Confirm your password here."		
"I am a talent scout. I can get you sponsored, but do not tell anyone yet."		
"Hey it is me, I lost my phone. Can you send a gift card code? I will pay you back."		
"You won a giveaway you did not enter. Claim within one hour."		
"I work for the game. Send your login and I will add the rare skin for free."		
"Your library book is due Thursday. Renew online or at the desk."		

QUESTION

One message is genuine. Which, and what makes it different? Be specific about the levers it does not pull.

Pressure and Trust

How grooming actually works

The picture most people have is a stranger asking something alarming straight away. Real cases almost never look like that.

It starts with **attention**: someone is unusually interested and kind. Then a **shared secret**, something small kept between you. Then **isolation**: hints that your parents would not understand, or that your friends would be jealous. Only then does a request arrive. By that point it feels like a request from a friend, which is the whole design.

THE THREE RULES

1. **Do not send.** Not once, not a cropped one, not "just to make them stop." There is no version of sending that improves the situation.
2. **Do not pay.** Paying tells them it works. It has never once ended a demand.
3. **Tell an adult today.** This is fixable and there are people whose actual job is fixing it. Nothing about this is your fault, and you are not in trouble.

SPOT THE STAGE

WHAT IS HAPPENING	WHICH STAGE	WHAT YOU WOULD DO
Someone you met online messages you far more than your actual friends do		
They ask you to move to a different app where messages disappear		
They say your parents would overreact if they knew about your conversations		
They send a gift or game currency and mention it was expensive		
They ask for a photo, then say they will share it unless you send another		

QUESTION 1

Row 2 is moving to a disappearing-message app. Explain why that request is a warning sign in itself.

QUESTION 2

Most young people in this situation do not tell anyone, because they feel it was their fault. Write what you would say to a friend who felt that.

Your Response Protocol

The protocol

- 1 **Stop responding.** Every reply gives them information and keeps the pressure running.
- 2 **Do not delete anything.** Instinct says erase it. Evidence is what lets an adult or a platform act. Screenshot, then leave it.
- 3 **Block and report in the app.** Both. Blocking protects you, reporting protects the next person.
- 4 **Tell a trusted adult today.** Not next week. These situations get harder to fix with time, and easier the sooner someone knows.
- 5 **Secure the account.** Change the password, turn on two-step verification, check for changes you did not make.

ORDER MATTERS

Someone acted on instinct and deleted everything before telling anyone. Explain what that costs.

WRITE YOUR SCRIPT

Telling an adult is easier when the first sentence already exists. Write yours.

A version that works: "Something happened online that I need help with. I am not in trouble, am I? Can I show you?"

MY THREE PEOPLE

WHO	HOW I WOULD REACH THEM

THE SENTENCE THAT MATTERS MOST

You will not be in trouble for telling. Not for what you clicked, what you sent, or how long you waited before saying something.

Skills Rubric

One rubric for all six lessons. Circle a level per row, or use it as a self-assessment.

SKILL	BEGINNING	DEVELOPING	SECURE	STRONG
Managing my footprint	Posts without considering audience or permanence.	Recognizes permanence but not passive collection.	Distinguishes posted, observed and inferred data.	Predicts what a stranger could infer and acts on it.
Account security	Reuses one password widely.	Knows reuse is risky but has not changed it.	Explains credential stuffing and uses 2FA.	Sequences a full compromise response correctly.
Privacy and data	Accepts default settings without noticing.	Knows data is collected but not what is inferred.	Names specific settings and their effect.	Identifies dark patterns and explains the steering.
Acting in groups	Participates in or silently watches pile-ons.	Recognizes harm after the fact.	Names three upstander moves and picks appropriately.	Acts, documents correctly, and reports in both places.
Verifying information	Judges credibility by appearance or popularity.	Knows to be skeptical but not how to check.	Reads laterally and traces to the original source.	Reaches an uncertain verdict and states what is missing.
Responding to pressure	Would not tell anyone.	Would tell someone eventually.	Names the protocol and a trusted adult.	Would act immediately, preserve evidence, and help a friend do the same.

HOW TO USE IT WITHOUT CREATING MARKING

- **Pick two rows, not five.** Assess the two skills the lesson actually taught. Leave the rest blank.
- **Have students circle first.** Then you circle. The conversation is about the gap between the two, and it takes thirty seconds per student.
- **Use it twice.** Once after Lesson 2 and once at the end. The movement between the two is the evidence, not the final score.

REPORTING LANGUAGE

Useful phrases: *distinguishes between data given, observed and inferred, explains the risk created by password reuse, identifies manipulation techniques in unfamiliar messages, reads laterally to verify a source, selects and justifies an appropriate upstander response, sequences an incident response correctly.*

Exit Tickets

Cut along the dashed lines. One ticket per student per lesson. Collect at the door.

Exit Ticket — Lesson 1

Name one thing in your footprint that you did not create. What will you do about it?

Exit Ticket — Lesson 2

Why is reusing a strong password more dangerous than using a weak unique one?

Exit Ticket — Lesson 3

Name one setting you will change tonight and what it stops.

Exit Ticket — Lesson 4

Write the exact sentence you would send to someone being piled on.

Exit Ticket — Lesson 5

What does a fact-checker do that most people do not?

Exit Ticket — Lesson 6

Name the four levers. Which one is the clearest sign that something is a scam?

Letter Home

Print, add your school letterhead, and send. The tone is deliberately calm rather than alarming.

Dear families,

Over the next few weeks your child is studying digital citizenship and online safety. The six lessons cover digital footprints and reputation, account security including two-step verification, what apps collect and infer, how group chats escalate, how to verify information and images, and how online scams and manipulation work.

Two things worth knowing. We do not use scare stories, because students who decide a risk has been exaggerated tend to discount everything else they were told. And no worksheet asks your child to record a real password, a real message, or any real personal information.

One lesson covers online pressure, including situations where someone asks a young person for images or money. It is handled without graphic detail, and the content is three rules: do not send, do not pay, tell an adult. If you would like to see that lesson before we teach it, please ask and I will send it to you.

One thing to do at home: tell your child, in plain words, that if something goes wrong online they will not lose their device for reporting it. Fear of losing access is the single most common reason young people stay silent, and staying silent is what turns a small problem into a serious one.

With thanks,

Teacher name and contact

WHY THIS LETTER IS SHORT

Long safety letters get skimmed. This one does three things only: says what is being taught, gives one thing to do at home, and names the fact that families can ask questions. That is the maximum that reliably gets read.

IF A FAMILY ASKS FOR MORE

THEY ASK	A SHORT ANSWER THAT WORKS
"Are you teaching them about things they have not even heard of yet?"	No. Every topic here is one students already meet. The lessons name it rather than introduce it, which is what lets a child recognize it later.
"Should I be reading their messages?"	That is a family decision, not a school one. What helps most in either case is that a child expects to be helped rather than punished when they report a problem.
"What if we do not allow devices at home?"	The lessons still apply. Students use school devices, friends' devices, and eventually their own. The habits transfer.
"Can I see the materials?"	Yes, and say yes readily. Every page is printable and there is nothing in the pack you would not want a family to read.

My Help Sheet

Fill this in **now**, while nothing is wrong. Then fold it and keep it somewhere you will find it.

THREE ADULTS I COULD TELL

One at home, one at school, one anywhere else. Write the name and how you would reach them.

1.

2.

3.

AT MY SCHOOL, THE PERSON WHOSE JOB THIS IS

Your teacher will give you this name.

Three things that are always true

- **You will not be in trouble for telling.** Not for what you clicked, what you sent, or how long you waited.
- **It was designed to work.** Scams are built by professionals and tested on thousands of people. Being caught is not a character flaw.
- **It gets easier to fix the sooner someone knows.** Every online problem is more solvable on day one than on day thirty.

FREE HELP LINES

IF THIS IS HAPPENING	WHO TO CONTACT
Someone is harassing or threatening you	Screenshot it, report in the app, and tell a trusted adult the same day.
Someone pressures you for images or money	Do not send, do not pay, do not delete evidence. Tell an adult today.
Someone else has accessed your account	Secure your email first, then change the password and turn on two-step verification.
Not sure whether it counts as a problem	Tell someone anyway. Adults would rather hear ten small things than miss one serious one.

THE ONE SENTENCE TO REMEMBER

If something online goes wrong, tell a trusted adult today. It is more fixable now than next week.

Answer Key

Model answers, not the only answers. For open questions, accept any response that meets the criterion named in bold.

LESSON 1: FOOTPRINT AND REPUTATION

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Q1	Usually column three. It reveals that students have no visibility of passive collection. Criterion: connects difficulty to invisibility.
P1 Q2	Two of: others have screenshots or reposts; the company retains it; it may be archived or cached; it may have been forwarded off-platform.
P2 Table	Available inferences: the school and grade, that they run competitively, a regular Saturday location, a probable Friday routine, a close relationship with one classmate, possible sleep difficulty, a recent bereavement, an approximate age.
P2 Q1	Uniform plus number identifies the school and the athlete; the running club's public times plus repeated coffee shop posts give a place and a window.
P2 Q2	It signals vulnerability. Someone building trust deliberately looks for a young person who is awake, alone, and not doing well, because sympathy is the fastest route to trust.
P3 Five-year test	Race photo passes. Midnight comment fails. In-joke usually fails, because it survives without its context. Political opinion is genuinely contested. Screenshot of a private conversation fails on consent grounds regardless of content.
P3 Difficult one	Criterion: distinguishes holding a view from posting it in a form that is careless, cruel, or unrecoverable. Accept a range of positions if reasoned.

LESSON 2: ACCOUNT SECURITY

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Table	All fall except any account with unique credentials or 2FA. Email is the worst: it enables password resets everywhere else.
P1 Q1	Email is the recovery route for every other account, so controlling it means controlling all of them, regardless of its contents.
P1 Q2	Old accounts still hold your credentials, are often on poorly maintained sites, and you will not notice a breach because you no longer log in.
P2 Ranking	1 E (passkey), 2 D, 3 B, 4 A, 5 C. Accept B above D with a strong justification about unique credentials.
P2 Q1	The attacker has the password but not the second factor, which is on a device they do not hold.
P2 Q2	Text messages can be intercepted or redirected through SIM swapping; app-based approval is tied to the device itself.
P2 Q3	Their argument: one breach exposes everything. The answer: the vault is strongly encrypted, the alternative in practice is reuse, and reuse is the risk that actually materializes.
P3 Part A	Order: secure email, change reused passwords, sign out sessions, check for attacker changes, enable 2FA, tell an adult. Accept telling an adult first.
P3 Part B	A forwarding rule or altered recovery address keeps the attacker's access alive after a password change.

Answer Key (continued)

LESSON 3: DATA TRAILS AND SETTINGS

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Sort	Given: 1, 4. Observed: 2, 5, 7, 8, 10. Inferred: 3, 6, 9.
P1 Q1	Unsent text reveals intent and hesitation, which is commercially and behaviorally informative. Capture usually occurs as you type, before any send decision.
P1 Q2	Nearby network names map to physical places, so location can be derived without the location permission.
P2 Inferences	Accept: school attendance and approximate school hours, age band, likely no car or no interest in cars, a probable close or romantic relationship, possible illness that week, heavy device use, and a stable home and school pair of locations.
P2 Q1	Health inferences can affect insurance, employment, and treatment by institutions, and they are often wrong while still being acted upon.
P2 Q2	Criterion: names a plausible inference and then a plausible innocent explanation , for example a relative in a different time zone. The point is that inference is probabilistic and consequences are not.
P3 Dark patterns	Accept: accepting all tracking; reversing a privacy decision through guilt; granting permanent location during a moment of low attention; discouraging reading through length.
P3 Question	Criterion: reframes from secrecy to control and asymmetry , without implying the person is doing something wrong.

LESSON 4: GROUP CHATS AND PILE-ONS

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Q1	51 people contributed. Nearly all would say they did almost nothing, which is precisely how it reaches that size.
P1 Q2	Two of: fear of becoming the next target; assuming someone else will; not wanting to seem humorless; not knowing what to say.
P1 Q3	Creating edits amplifies reach and extends the lifespan of the material, which is a larger contribution than a single comment, not a smaller one.
P1 Q4	It changes the target's experience from universal hostility to not-universal, which is the difference that matters most to the person receiving it.
P2 Table	1: moves 1 and 2. 2: move 1, plus 3 if it is identifiable and spreading. 3: move 3, document and report, plus blocking. 4: a direct private conversation. 5: acknowledge directly and privately, and stop the spread.
P3 Part A	Needed: username, date and time, surrounding context, chat name. Your own reply is optional but often useful.
P3 Part B	In-app reporting can remove content and sanction the account. Telling an adult brings school processes, support for the target, and follow-up. Neither substitutes for the other.

Answer Key (continued)

LESSON 5: CHECKING WHAT YOU SEE

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Practice	Row 1: search the site name plus "who owns" or "funding". Row 2: search the claim plus "study" to find the original. Row 3: search the claim itself, not the account. Row 4: search the headline text to find whether the article exists.
P1 Question	A screenshot cannot be traced to a source, can be fabricated in seconds, and removes the article that would provide context. The move is to search the headline text.
P2 Claim A	False or unsupported. Anonymous, no source, an account with a pattern of similar content, and a district decision of that kind would be officially announced.
P2 Claim B	Likely reliable, with a caveat: the university has an interest in promoting its own research, so the study itself is the thing to read.
P2 Claim C	Treat as false until corroborated. A new account plus a startling statement plus no other coverage is the standard synthetic-media pattern.
P2 Claim D	Uncertain, and this is the correct verdict. It could be a genuine individual experience. One report is not evidence of a pattern, and it is also not evidence of a lie.
P3 Q1	Familiarity plus authority. The face is trusted, the format looks like an endorsement, and the scam borrows credibility it never earned.
P3 Q2	Blanket disbelief is exactly what manipulation benefits from, because it removes the difference between checked and unchecked claims. The better response is to shift trust from appearance to provenance.

LESSON 6: SCAMS AND MANIPULATION

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Table	1: U, A. 2: R, S. 3: U, A. 4: R, U. 5: A, R. 6: none, genuine.
P1 Question	Message 6. No urgency, no reward, no secrecy, no request for credentials, and it offers an ordinary offline alternative.
P2 Table	1: attention. 2: isolation, and moving off-platform removes evidence and oversight. 3: isolation. 4: obligation, manufacturing a debt. 5: the demand stage.
P2 Q1	It removes the record, moves the conversation away from safety features and parental visibility, and creates a sense of privacy that makes escalation easier.
P2 Q2	Criterion: places responsibility on the person applying pressure, and states plainly that telling an adult is the right move and carries no punishment.
P3 Order matters	Deleting removes the evidence platforms and schools need to act, makes the account harder to trace, and can make the student feel less believed.

IF YOU ONLY MARK ONE THING

Read the Lesson 6 page 3 responses. A student who cannot name an adult they would tell is the reason this pack exists.



Thank You

Built by a classroom teacher who still teaches this every year.

If this worked in your room

- **Leaving feedback earns you TPT credits** toward future purchases, and it genuinely helps other teachers find the pack.
- **Found a typo or a thing that did not land?** Message me through TPT. I fix things and re-upload, and you get the update free.
- **Follow the store** to hear when new packs go up. New resources are half price for the first 24 hours.

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PACK	GRADES	GOOD FOR
Digital Citizenship & Online Safety	3 to 5	The elementary version, with simpler language and the same structure.
Digital Citizenship & Online Safety	9 to 12	The high school version, covering consent, fraud, algorithms, and digital law.
AI-Resistant Assessment Pack	7 to 12	Redesigning tasks so that AI use stops being the question.
Emergency Sub Plans	Various	Full-day, no-prep plans for the day you cannot be there.

THREE THINGS WORTH DOING AFTER THIS PACK

- **Put the help sheet somewhere permanent.** Inside a folder, on the inside of a locker door, in the back of a planner. It only works if it is findable in the moment it is needed.
- **Revisit one idea a month.** Two minutes at the start of a period. Ask what students have noticed since. This is what turns six lessons into a culture.
- **Tell your colleagues the reporting name.** The most common failure in a school is not that students do not report, it is that the adult they told did not know where to send it.

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Clarence Goh has taught digital technologies for over twenty years. Digital Vector resources are written to be run by any teacher, in any room, with a printer and nothing else.

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